Sinwar's Will

I am Yahya, son of the refugee who turned exile into a temporary homeland, and turned the dream into an eternal struggle.
As I write these words I summon every moment that has passed in my life: from my childhood among the alleys, to the long years in prison, to every drop of blood spilled on the soil of this land.

I was born in Khan Yunis camp in 1962, at a time when Palestine was a torn memory and maps forgotten on politicians' tables.
I am the man whose life I wove between fire and ash, who understood early on that life under occupation means nothing but perpetual imprisonment.

From the cradle I knew that life on this land is not ordinary, and that whoever is born here must carry in his heart an unbreakable weapon, and must understand that the road to freedom is long.
My testament to you begins here, from that child who threw the first stone at the occupier, who learned that stones are the first words we speak when confronting a world that stands silent before our wound.

I learned in the streets of Gaza that a person is not measured by the years of his life but by what he gives to his homeland. Thus my life was: prisons and battles, pain and hope.
I entered prison for the first time in 1988 and was sentenced to life, but I did not know the way of fear.

In those dark cells I saw in every wall a window to a distant horizon, and in every bar a light that lights the path to freedom.
In prison I learned that patience is not merely a virtue but a weapon, a bitter weapon, like drinking the sea drop by drop.

My testament to you: do not fear prisons; they are only part of our long road to freedom.
Prison taught me that freedom is not just a stolen right but an idea born of pain and forged by patience. When I was released in the "Wafa' al-Ahrar" exchange in 2011, I did not come out as I had been; I came out stronger, my faith deepened that what we do is not a passing struggle but our destiny to carry to the last drop of our blood.

My counsel is that you remain clinging to the rifle, to the dignity that does not bargain, and to the dream that does not die. The enemy wants us to abandon resistance, to turn our cause into endless negotiation.
But I tell you: do not negotiate away what is your right. They fear your steadfastness more than they fear your weapon. Resistance is not merely a weapon we carry; it is our love for Palestine in every breath we take, it is our will to remain despite the blockade and aggression.

My counsel is that you remain faithful to the blood of the martyrs, to those who departed and left us this thorny road. They paved the way to freedom with their blood, so do not squander those sacrifices in the calculations of politicians and diplomatic games.
We are here to continue what the predecessors began, and we will not deviate from this path no matter the cost. Gaza was and will remain the capital of steadfastness, the heart of Palestine that does not stop beating, even if the earth grows narrow for us.

When I assumed leadership of Hamas in Gaza in 2017, it was not simply a transfer of power but a continuation of a resistance that began with the stone and continued with the rifle. Every day I felt the people's pain under siege, and I knew that every step we take toward freedom comes at a price. But I tell you: the price of surrender is far greater. Therefore, cling to the land as a root clings to soil, no wind can uproot a people who have decided to live.

In the Battle of the Al-Aqsa Flood, I was not a leader of a group or movement alone; I was the voice of every Palestinian who dreams of liberation. My faith led me to believe that resistance is not merely an option but a duty. I wanted this battle to be a new page in the book of Palestinian struggle, where the factions unite and everyone stands in the same trench against an enemy that has never distinguished between child and elder, or between stone and tree.

The Al-Aqsa Flood was a battle for souls before bodies, for will before weapon.
What I leave behind is not a personal legacy but a collective one, for every Palestinian who dreamed of freedom, for every mother who carried her son on her shoulder as a martyr, for every father who burned with grief for his little daughter struck down by a treacherous bullet.

My final counsel is that you always remember that resistance is not senseless, nor is it merely a fired bullet; it is a life we live with honor and dignity. Prison and siege taught me that the struggle is long and the road is arduous, but I also learned that peoples who refuse to surrender create their miracles with their own hands.

Do not expect the world to do you justice; I lived and witnessed how the world remains silent before our pain. Do not wait for fairness, be the fairness yourselves. Carry the dream of Palestine in your hearts, make every wound a weapon, and every tear a spring of hope.

This is my testament: do not surrender your weapons, do not throw away the stones, do not forget your martyrs, and do not bargain away a dream that is your right.
We remain here, on our land, in our hearts, and in the future of our children.

I entrust you with Palestine, the land I loved unto death, and the dream I carried on my shoulders like a mountain that does not bow.
If I fall, do not fall with me; instead carry a banner that has never fallen, and make my blood a bridge crossed by a generation born from our ashes, stronger. Do not forget that the homeland is not a tale to be told but a reality to be lived, and in every martyr a thousand resistors are born from the womb of this land.

If the flood returns and I am not among you, know that I was the first drop in the waves of freedom, and that I lived to see you continue the march.
Be a thorn in their throat, a deluge that does not retreat, and that rests only when the world recognizes that we are the rightful owners, and that we are not mere numbers on news reports.